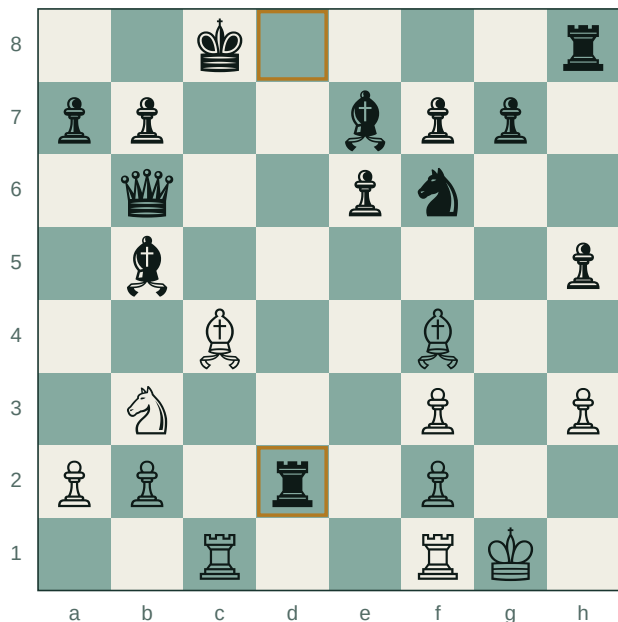


Double checks: White, move 18

Double checks

White to move



Previous move: 17...Rxd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18. Bxe6+ Kd8 19. Rc8#

18.Bxe6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The changed line means the rook on c1 attacks the king on c8. Recorded reply: **18...Kd8**.

19.Rc8# Mate: rook on c8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on d8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on c8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on c8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8 and bishop on e7. Check for tactical protection.